Office of the City Clerk
330 W. 20th Avenue
San Mateo, CA 94403

Ballot Measure Primary Argument Submission Form

A ballot argument will not be accepted unless accompanied by this completed **typed** form, which shall contain the printed name(s) and signature(s) of the person(s) submitting it or, if submitted on behalf of a bona fide association of citizens, the name of the association and the printed name and signature of at least one of its principal officers.

Word count limit for Primary Arguments = 300 words

Ballot Measure _____ for the General Election to be held on November 3, 2026.

☑ Primary Argument in Favor of ☐ Primary Argument Against

This argument is submitted by (check ONLY ONE):	
☑	The San Mateo City Council: San Mateo City Council
	Name of Governing Body: San Mateo City Council
	Contact Person's Printed Name: Danielle Ewirka-Godycki
	Ph[redacted] [redacted]
☐	**Member(s) of the County of San Mateo Board of Supervisors or the Governing Body of a School District or Special District**
	Name of Governing Body:
	Contact Person's Printed Name:
	Phone: / Email:
☐	**Bona Fide Association of Citizens** If this argument is filed by a bona fide association of citizens, the signers of the argument must be affiliated with the association and be authorized to sign the argument on its behalf. Provide the printed name and signature of at least one principal officer of the association.
	Name of Association:
	Contact Person's Printed Name:
	Phone: / Email:
☐	**Individual Voters Eligible to Vote on the Measure**
	Contact Person's Printed Name:
	Phone: / Email:
☐	**Combination of Voters and Associations**
	Contact Person's Printed Name:
	Phone: / Email:

Arguments will be emailed to the contact person listed here for review before they are printed in the Sample Ballot & Official Voter Information Pamphlets.

Please complete the reverse side of this form.

Primary Argument Signers Form	Author	Verified
No more than five signatures shall appear with any argument. If more than five signatures are submitted, the first five listed shall be printed. Names and titles listed will be printed in the order that they are listed below. Place a checkmark in the author column if the signer is the author of the argument. A signer can only list one title. Honorifics such as M.D., Dr., Esquire, etc. with a name are not accepted. If the signers are part of a bona fide association, there is no requirement that they be eligible to vote on the measure. However, for each such signing individual, the title under the signer's name must list the name of that bona fide association and may include their position within that association. By signing below, the undersigned state that they have read the argument and believe it not to be false or misleading. **Type** information clearly.	Check if the signer is the author of the argument. Authors must be signers.	(FOR OFFICIAL USE ONLY) Staff check once the eligibility of the signer is verified.

1.	Name: Danielle Cwirko-Godycki	Title: San Mateo City Councilmember	☑	☐
	Phone: [redacted]	Email: [redacted]		
	Address: [redacted] San Mateo CA, 94401		Pronouns:	
	Signatur[redacted]	Date: 8/9/2026	He/His: ☐ She/Her: ☑ They/Them: ☐	
2.	Name: Nicole Fernandez	Title: Deputy Mayor, City of San Mateo	☑	☐
	Phone: [redacted]	Email: [redacted]		
	Address: [redacted] San Mateo, CA, 94401		Pronouns:	
	[redacted]	Date: 8/9/26	He/His: ☐ She/Her: ☑ They/Them: ☐	
3.	Name: Michael Etheridge	Title:	☐	☐
	Phone: [redacted]	Email: [redacted]		
	Address: [redacted] San Mateo, CA, 94402		Pronouns:	
	Signature[redacted]	Date: 8/9/2026	He/His: ☑ She/Her: ☐ They/Them: ☐	
4.	Name: Richard W Hedges	Title: Former City Council Member	☐	☐
	Phone: [redacted]	Email: [redacted]		
	Address: [redacted] San Mateo, CA 94401-2011		Pronouns:	
	[redacted]	Date: 08/09/2026	He/His: ☐ She/Her: ☐ They/Them: ☐	
5.	Name: Gloria K. Brown	Title:	☐	☐
	[redacted]	Email: [redacted]		
	[redacted] San Mateo, CA 94401		Pronouns:	
	Sign[redacted]	Date: August 9, 2026	He/His: ☐ She/Her: ☐ They/Them: ☐	

Submit a second form (this side only) for alternate signers attached to this form and the argument.

Vote YES to Update San Mateo's City Charter

San Mateo's City Charter establishes the basic rules for how our local government operates. Portions were written decades ago and no longer reflect California law or how our City operates today.

These are practical, commonsense updates.

Voting YES will formally update the Charter to reflect San Mateo's district-based elections and require district boundaries to be reviewed after each federal census.

It will also make straightforward administrative changes, including providing additional time to fill a vacant City Council seat and allowing the Council to set the day and time of regular meetings by public resolution rather than permanently fixing them in the Charter.

The measure also removes outdated provisions from our former at-large election system and language no longer required under state law.

San Mateo is one of only two charter cities in San Mateo County. Having our own Charter gives residents important local control over how our City is governed. With that privilege comes a responsibility to periodically update it so our rules remain clear, legally compliant, and relevant.

These changes don't raise taxes, create new programs, or fundamentally change how our City is governed. They simply make our Charter clearer, more practical, and consistent with current law and how San Mateo operates today.

This is a straightforward update to a document that should accurately reflect the community and government it serves.

Please join us in voting **YES to update San Mateo's City Charter.**

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